INTRODUCTION

India stands at the cusp of a materials revolution. From speciality chemicals powering semiconductor fabrication to advanced composites in defence and aerospace, from rare earth processing for electric vehicle batteries to high-performance polymers for 5G infrastructure — the advanced materials sector is quietly becoming the backbone of India's manufacturing ambitions under "Make in India" and the Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes.

Yet this sector remains dramatically under-researched by equity analysts. While every brokerage house covers IT services and banking ad nauseam, the companies engineering the physical materials that make modern technology possible receive a fraction of the analytical attention they deserve. This creates information asymmetry — and where information asymmetry exists, opportunity lives.

This competition challenges you to become the equity research analyst that the market needs but does not yet have — one who understands both the science of materials AND the science of valuation.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Evaluate the investment potential of India's listed advanced materials and speciality chemicals companies in the context of the ongoing materials revolution driven by EVs, semiconductors,

defence indigenisation, and the China+1 supply chain shift.

Identify the single best-positioned listed stock with the strongest growth potential, conduct a comprehensive equity research analysis, and present a compelling investment thesis with a clear BUY / HOLD / SELL recommendation supported by rigorous valuation.

Your equity research report must demonstrate:

1. Deep understanding of material science fundamentals — you must understand WHAT the company makes, WHY it matters, and HOW it is manufactured. Judges will test this. A report that treats "speciality chemicals" as a generic black box will score poorly.

2. Rigorous financial analysis: DCF valuation, relative valuation (P/E, EV/EBITDA, P/S, P/B), scenario analysis, and sensitivity testing. Show your working. Judges are CAs and financial market professionals — they will verify your numbers.

3. Investment thesis with conviction not a wishy-washy "it depends." Take a clear position (BUY, HOLD, or SELL), state your target price and time horizon, and defend it.

4. Risk assessment that goes beyond generic lists identify risks specific to this company and this sector, quantify their impact where possible, and explain your mitigation thesis.

SCOPE OF ANALYSIS Sub-Sectors Within Material Sciences

Teams must select ONE company from the Indian listed equity universe that operates primarily in one or more of the following material science sub-sectors:

A. Speciality Chemicals & Advanced Intermediates

Companies producing performance chemicals, agrochemical intermediates, pharmaceutical APIs, electronic chemicals, or functional additives. These companies are benefiting from China+1 diversification and increasing complexity of end-products.

B. Advanced Composites & High-Performance Materials

Companies producing carbon fibre composites, aramid fibres, technical textiles, ceramic matrix composites, or metal matrix composites for aerospace, defence, automotive, or industrial applications.

C. Battery Materials & Energy Storage Chemistry

Companies involved in cathode/anode materials, electrolyte chemistry, battery separator films, lithium processing, or recycling of battery metals. This includes companies in the nickel, cobalt, and graphite value chains.

D. Semiconductor & Electronic Materials

Companies producing ultra-high-purity chemicals, speciality gases, photoresists, CMP (Chemical Mechanical Polishing) slurries, lead frames, substrates, or packaging materials for semiconductor and electronics manufacturing.

MANDATORY DELIVERABLES

Deliverable 1: Equity Research Report (PDF, Maximum 15 pages including Cover page & Appendix)

Should clearly indicate a BUY/SELL/HOLD rating for the stock chosen.

Should include at least 2 valuation models that support your rationale of BUY/SELL/HOLD.

All the assumptions regarding the future growth outlook must be clearly stated.

Should include:

1. Material Sciences Industry Overview
2. Competitive Landscape
3. Company Overview
4. Financial Analysis
5. Valuation
6. Investment Thesis
7. ESG Analysis
8. Appendix

Deliverable 2: Presentation Deck (PDF/PPTX, Maximum 10 slides including Cover page & Appendix)

Presentation structure is upto the teams, there are no prerequisites for it. Teams can showcase the most relevant section of the report in the presentation as per their choice.

Your presentation to the judges panel must follow this structure. You will have 10 minutes to present + 5 minutes Q&A

Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Weight	What Judges Will Assess
Industry Analysis	30%	Depth of material science understanding. Quality of competitive analysis. Evidence of original research beyond annual reports. PESTEL rigour with sector-specific insights.
Equity Report	65%	Financial analysis accuracy. DCF model quality and assumption justification. Relative valuation rigour. Conviction and clarity of investment thesis. Risk assessment specificity. ESG integration.
Presentation Design	5%	Visual clarity. Professional formatting. Effective data visualisation. Slide economy (less text, more insight).

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

• Submission link to be provided on the competition platform

• Both deliverables (Report PDF + Presentation PDF/PPTX) must be submitted as a single submission

• File naming convention: TeamName_CollegeName_Report.pdf and TeamName_CollegeName_Presentation.pptx

• Late submissions will not be accepted under any circumstances

• Ensure all files open correctly before submitting — corrupted files will not be evaluated

RULES & CONSTRAINTS

1. Company Selection: Must be a company listed on NSE or BSE as of the competition start date. Must operate primarily in material sciences, speciality chemicals, advanced materials, or closely related sectors. Pure IT/banking/FMCG companies are NOT eligible — the company must have a material science core.
2. Originality: All analysis must be original work produced during the 7-day competition period. Copying from brokerage research reports will result in disqualification. Judges have access to major brokerage databases and will check.
3. Data Sources: Use publicly available data only — annual reports, investor presentations, exchange filings, regulatory documents, industry reports. Cite ALL sources. Unsourced claims will not receive credit.
4. Plagiarism: Instant disqualification. This includes copying from brokerage reports, other teams, or AI-generated content without substantial original analysis layered on top. Judges will evaluate analytical originality.